

Abang Cebu AI

Renter Persona, Access Rights, and Feature Permissions

1. Purpose and Source Basis

This document defines the Renter user, called the "finder" in the AbangCebu AI Updated Technology Stack document. It records what a renter can do, what a renter is explicitly blocked from doing, and how a new student renter is guided through first use.

Items marked Source come directly from the technology stack document. Items marked Proposed are design decisions added to complete the persona. The source does not mention favorites, student users, or onboarding, so those are Proposed and are listed again in Section 9 for confirmation.

Item	Source	Basis
Finder actor, map, price markers, rental cards	Source	System flow and mapping sections
Conversational search, e.g. "private room near Cebu IT Park under PHP 5,000 with Wi-Fi"	Source	Artificial Intelligence section
Radius, landmark, and map-area search	Source	PostGIS section
AI is read-only and returns only approved records	Source	Artificial Intelligence section
Contact information is protected	Source	"Protect private information" (Route Handlers)
Save favorites, student onboarding, in-app contact flow	Proposed	Needed for this deliverable; not in source

2. Renter Persona

The persona below is an illustrative composite for design purposes. It is not based on user research.

Persona	Student Renter (illustrative name: "Mika", 20, college student relocating to Metro Cebu)
Role in system	renter (called "finder" in the source document)
Goal	Find an affordable, safe room or apartment close to campus or a work-study location, and contact the landlord quickly.
Typical need	Private room or bedspace near a landmark, within a fixed monthly budget, with essentials such as Wi-Fi.
Context of use	Mostly on a phone, often on mobile data, comparing several places in one sitting.
Pain points	Unclear locations, listings that are outdated or unavailable, hard to judge walking distance, unsure who to trust.
What builds trust	Every listing is approved by an admin; the map shows real locations; the AI only recommends approved records.
Not a goal	Posting listings or managing properties. That is the landlord role.

3. Access Rights Summary

Area	Renter access
Authentication	Signs in through Supabase Authentication. One account holds exactly one role.
Public routes	/, /map, /search, /listings/[id] (approved listings only).
Renter routes	/renter/* (renter home, favorites) and /account/* (own profile).
Blocked routes	/landlord/* and /admin/* return a 403 page. /login and /register redirect a signed-in renter to the renter home.
Data visibility	Approved listings only. Pending, draft, rejected, and unpublished listings are never visible to a renter.
Own data	Own profile and own favorites only, enforced by <code>user_id = auth.uid()</code> in Row Level Security.

4. Renter Capabilities

Permission IDs P01 to P07 match the formal RBAC specification. P23 is new and is added for favorites.

Capability	What the renter can do	Permission	Endpoint	Basis
View map	Open the Metro Cebu map, see rental markers and price markers, pan and zoom, and select a marker to open its rental card.	P01 map:view	GET /api/listings	Source
Filter listings	Search by landmark, radius, or visible map area. Filter by price, room type, and amenities such as Wi-Fi. Results update the map markers and rental cards together.	P02 listing:search	GET /api/listings	Source (radius, area, price, Wi-Fi). Other filters Proposed.
View listing details	See photos, price, description, availability, and distance from a selected location.	P03 listing:read	GET /api/listings/:id	Source
Chat with AI agent	Describe needs in plain language. The assistant turns the request into search criteria and returns approved listings as cards and markers.	P05 assistant:use	POST /api/ai/chat	Source
Save favorites	Save or remove an approved listing from a personal favorites list and review it later at /renter/favorites.	P23 favorite:manage_own	GET/POST /api/me/favorites, DELETE /api/me/favorites/:listingId	Proposed
Contact landlord	View the landlord's contact details on an approved listing, then reach out through those details.	P04 contact:read	GET /api/listings/:id/contact	Source (protected data). Flow Proposed.
Manage own profile	View and edit own name, contact number, and preferences.	P06, P07	GET/PATCH /api/me	Proposed

Notes on the capabilities:

- Contact landlord uses the contact details shown to the renter. The source does not define in-app messaging, so this document does not assume it. If messaging is added later, it needs its own permission.
- Favorites apply only to approved listings. If a favorited listing is later unpublished or archived, it is hidden from the renter's favorites view rather than deleted, and it reappears if the listing is approved again.

- Guests can view the map, filter listings, and use the AI assistant with rate limits. Only a signed-in renter can save favorites or view landlord contact details.

5. AI Assistant Behavior for Renters

When a renter types, for example, "Find me a private room near Cebu IT Park under PHP 5,000 with Wi-Fi," the assistant follows these rules.

- It converts the request into structured search criteria and calls server-controlled, read-only rental-search tools (Source).
- It has no direct database access and cannot create, edit, approve, or delete listings (Source).
- Every recommendation comes from approved records returned by the application (Source).
- It does not return landlord contact details. The renter opens the listing and uses the contact action, which passes the normal permission check (Proposed).
- It cannot save favorites on the renter's behalf unless the renter confirms the action in the interface (Proposed).
- Results appear as map markers and rental cards, the same as manual search.

6. Restricted Actions

A renter is explicitly denied every action below. The system denies by default, so any action not listed in Section 4 is also denied.

Group	Restricted action	Permission or rule	Endpoint
Listings	Create a listing	P08 listing:create	POST /api/listings
Listings	Edit listing details, submit for approval, archive or delete a listing	P10, P11, P12	PATCH/DELETE /api/listings/:id
Listings	Upload or remove property photos	P13 photo:manage_own	POST /api/listings/:id/photos
Listings	Update availability	P14 availability:update_own	PUT /api/listings/:id/availability
Landlord area	Access the landlord dashboard or any /landlord/* page	Role landlord required	GET /api/landlord/listings
Moderation	Approve, reject, or unpublish a listing	P16, P17, P18	POST /api/admin/listings/:id/*
Moderation	View pending, draft, rejected, or unpublished listings	P15 listing:read_all	GET /api/admin/listings
Administration	Access the admin console or any /admin/* page	P22 admin_console:access	/admin/* routes
Administration	View the user list, change any role (including own), suspend or reactivate accounts	P19, P20, P21	/api/admin/users*
Other users' data	View or edit another user's profile or favorites	Ownership rule	/api/me* scoped to session user
AI misuse	Use the assistant to write data, read private data, or reach the database	Not permitted for any role	POST /api/ai/chat tool layer

Enforcement and response

Attempt	Result
Renter opens /landlord/* or /admin/*	Server renders a 403 page with HTTP status 403. No redirect to the renter's own area.
Renter calls a restricted API endpoint	HTTP 403 Forbidden, code FORBIDDEN_ROLE, message: "You do not have permission to perform this action."
Renter requests a listing that is not approved	HTTP 404 Not Found, so the listing's existence is not revealed.
Signed-out visitor opens /renter/*	302 redirect to /login?next=<path>. API calls return 401 UNAUTHENTICATED.
Renter account is suspended	HTTP 403, code ACCOUNT_SUSPENDED, on every guarded endpoint.
Renter tries to send a role value at registration or profile update	The server ignores it. The role is read from the database record only.

Controls apply in four layers: Next.js middleware (coarse gate), Route Handler guards (authoritative), Supabase Row Level Security (data layer), and the read-only AI tool layer. The interface also hides restricted buttons, but that is for usability only and is never relied on for security.

7. Onboarding Experience for Student Renters

All onboarding steps are Proposed. The design goal is to show value before asking for an account, keep sign-up short, and get the student to a saved favorite and a landlord contact in the first session.

Step	Experience	Who
1. Land as a guest	The student opens AbangCebu and sees the Metro Cebu map with approved rental markers and prices right away. No sign-up wall.	Guest
2. Try a search	A prompt in the search bar suggests: "Find a private room near Cebu IT Park under PHP 5,000 with Wi-Fi." The student can type their own campus or landmark.	Guest (AI rate-limited)
3. Hit a gated action	When the student taps Save or Show contact, a short prompt explains that a free account is needed to save favorites and view landlord contact details.	Guest
4. Register as a renter	Sign-up asks for email and password. The role is set to renter by default, and the only other choice offered is landlord. Admin is never offered.	Guest -> Renter
5. Quick profile	Optional, skippable: preferred landmark or campus, monthly budget, and must-have amenities. These prefill filters and are editable later in /account.	Renter
6. Guided first result	The map centers on the chosen landmark and shows results within a default radius. A short tip points out price markers, the filter panel, and the AI chat.	Renter
7. Save and compare	The student saves two or three listings and reviews them in /renter/favorites.	Renter
8. Contact a landlord	The student opens a listing, taps Show contact, and reaches out through the details shown. A safety reminder is displayed at this step.	Renter

Onboarding rules

- The student can browse, filter, and use the AI assistant before registering.
- Registration collects the minimum data needed. Profile details are optional.
- A signed-in renter who visits /register or /login is redirected to the renter home.

- Onboarding tips are dismissible and shown once, with a way to reopen them from account settings.
- The safety reminder at contact time suggests meeting in public, viewing the place in person, and never paying before verification. Wording is to be reviewed by the team.
- Onboarding never exposes landlord or admin features, and a renter who wants to list a property is told to register a separate landlord account, since one account holds one role.

Student-specific considerations (Proposed)

- Budget-first filters with the price shown on map markers, matching the source's price-marker design.
- Distance to a chosen campus or landmark shown on every rental card, using PostGIS distance calculation (Source).
- Mobile-first layout, since the source specifies responsive styling with Tailwind CSS.
- Plain-language AI replies, with example prompts on first use.

8. Acceptance Criteria Check

Criterion	Where covered	Status
Document renter capabilities: view map, filter listings, chat with AI agent, save favorites, contact landlord	Section 4 (with AI rules in Section 5)	Covered
Explicitly list restricted actions, including no create or edit listings and no landlord dashboard	Section 6	Covered
Document onboarding experience for student renters	Section 7	Covered

9. Assumptions to Confirm

1. Renter is the same as "finder" in the source document.
2. Favorites are a required feature. The source does not mention them, so this adds permission P23 and the `/api/me/favorites` endpoints.
3. Contact landlord means viewing contact details, not in-app messaging.
4. Student renters are a primary audience. The source only implies this through its Cebu IT Park example.
5. Guests may use the AI assistant with rate limits, but must sign in to save favorites or view contact details.
6. Filters beyond price, distance, and Wi-Fi (for example room type) are acceptable additions.
7. A person who is both a renter and a landlord uses two accounts.